REKINDLED.
WHERE REAL FRIENDSHIPS BEGIN

The end of loneliness as *a default setting.*

A standalone read on the company, the market, the product, the data, and the round.
Read in 12 minutes. Keep on file.

TL;DR

i.

What we are

A small-group, swipe-to-match social-events app. Strangers match into a real-world event sourced from Eventbrite & Ticketmaster. AI-warmed group chat before. Group chat after.

ii.

Why it works

Recurring small-group, in-person contact is what reliably turns acquaintances into friends — the variable no incumbent owns end-to-end.

iii.

Where we are

Closed beta live in NYC. Pre-launch indicators ahead of paid traction; full cohort metrics targeted before next raise.

iv.

The model & the ask

Free first hang → $10/hang or $25/mo unlimited. Raising $500K pre-seed for a 12-month NYC milestone push.

THE PROBLEM WE'RE SOLVING

Adults stopped making friends. *Apps made it worse.*

Every existing solution is optimized for the wrong objective: matches (dating apps), attendance (Eventbrite), audience (Discord), or vanity (Instagram). None are optimized for friendship.

REKINDLED.

BY THE NUMBERS

MAGNITUDE

Loneliness is mainstream — *measurable, mortal, named.*

In May 2023 the U.S. Surgeon General issued an 81-page advisory naming loneliness and social isolation a public-health crisis. The data behind it is unambiguous.

≈50%

of U.S. adults report experiencing loneliness

U.S. Surgeon General Advisory, 2023

15 /day

cigarettes — the mortality-risk equivalent of being socially disconnected (≈26–29% higher premature-death risk)

Holt-Lunstad meta-analysis, cited in 2023 SG Advisory

$6.7 B

in extra annual Medicare spending tied to social isolation in older adults

Flowers et al., AARP Public Policy Institute, 2017

5×

rise in U.S. men reporting *no* close friends — from 3% (1990) to 15% (2021)

Survey Center on American Life, May 2021

HOURS TO FRIENDSHIP

Friendship is built on time: ~50 hrs to a casual friend, ~90 hrs to a friend, 200+ hrs to a close friend. Hall, J. Soc. Pers. Relat., 2018

IN-PERSON SOCIALIZING COLLAPSED

Ages 15–25: 61 → 39 min/day spent socializing in person, 2003 → 2019. BLS American Time Use Survey

Three shifts converging in 2026.

i. **Friendship recession**
Remote work eliminated the third place. The U.S. Surgeon General named loneliness a public-health crisis in 2023.

ii. **Dating-app fatigue**
Public earnings from Bumble and Match Group through 2024–25 show declining paying users and rising fatigue with romance-first swiping.

iii. **AI hosts now economical**
An LLM-powered host can keep group chats alive between hangs at near-zero marginal cost — the unit economics that killed prior small-group attempts now work.

THE NON-OBVIOUS THING

The bottleneck isn't meeting people. *It's seeing them again.*

Friendship is built by hours of repeated contact, not by a single introduction. Casual one-off events deliver the introduction, then disperse.

Rekindled is the first product engineered for the second hang, the third hang, the fourth hang — not for the first introduction.

A three-act loop, designed to compound.

BEFORE

Don't walk in blind.

Swipe local events. Match into a small group 48hr ahead. See faces. Trade messages. Show up un-anxious.

DURING

The activity carries you.

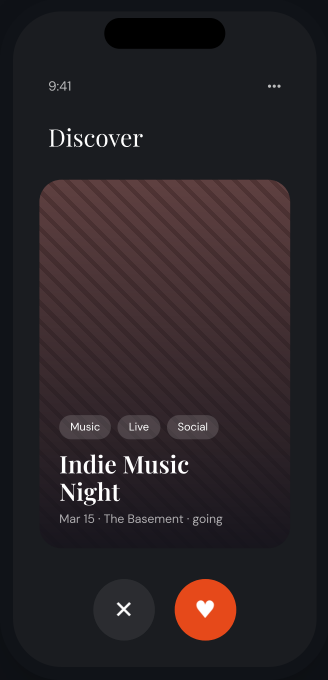
Concerts, classes, comedy, run clubs — sourced live from Eventbrite & Ticketmaster. The activity does the conversational heavy lifting; nobody has to invent the night.

AFTER

One hang plants the seed.

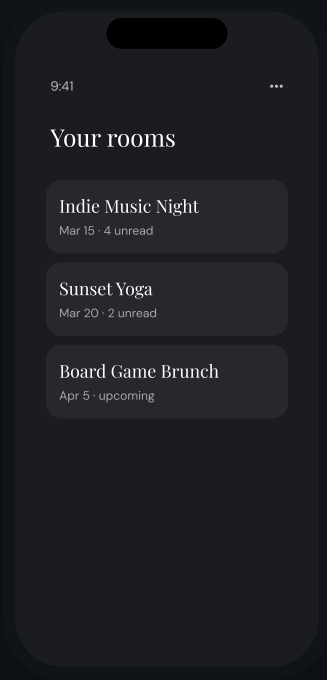
Group chat persists. Rekindled AI keeps it warm. Follow-up hangs auto-suggest if engagement passes a threshold.

One app. Three jobs. Live in NYC today.



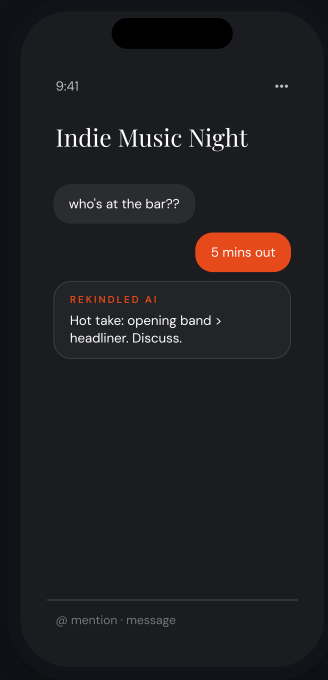
Swipe Feed

Live events from Eventbrite & Ticketmaster, tagged by activity, vibe, and group size.



Group Rooms

Matched attendees per event. Real-time chat with @mentions.



Rekindled AI

Always-on host bot. Drops prompts and playful hot takes between hangs.

Four compounding advantages.

01 · Supply & curation layer

Live event supply via Eventbrite & Ticketmaster integrations, filtered through a curation algorithm tuned for small-group social fit. Anyone can hit the same APIs; what's hard is knowing which events convert into friendships — and that's a feedback-loop advantage that compounds with every cohort.

02 · Match-quality data

Every hang generates structured feedback that improves matching over time. Match-quality compounds with volume — a moat that grows with every cohort.

03 · Friend-graph

Once a user has 2+ friends from Rekindled, leaving means leaving the friendship behind. Social graphs are the deepest moat in consumer software.

04 · Brand

Editorial, anti-app aesthetic positions us against the dating-app malaise. Brand defensibility matters in a category where users are exhausted by sameness.

REKINDLED.

TAM · SAM · SOM

MARKET SIZING

A $48B addressable wallet. *Sized bottom-up.*

TAM

$312B

Global out-of-home leisure spend by 22–38s. 22% cohort share of $1.4T category (PwC).

SAM

$48B

71M US & UK 22–38s × ~$680/yr discretionary social spend (BLS CEX + ONS).

SOM · YEAR 3

$84M

12 cities · 360K paying users · $232 blended ARPU. ~0.18% of SAM.

Bottom-up SOM math · 12 launch cities × 30K paying users/city = 360K. Pricing mix: 30% on $25/mo unlimited (~$300/yr) + 70% on pay-per-hang ($10 × ~6 hangs/yr = $60/yr) → **$232 blended ARPU** → **$83.5M ARR**. We hit $84M ARR by capturing under one-fifth of one percent of the addressable wallet — a category-defining outcome with room to compound.

REFERENCE EXITS · ADJACENT CATEGORIES

City-by-city. Density first. *Then expansion.*

PHASE	CITIES	GOAL	APPROACH
Pre-seed (now)	NYC	Prove unit economics at density	Beta in NYC where event supply is dense (Eventbrite + Ticketmaster)
Seed	+ second city	Validate playbook portability	Lift NYC playbook into a second metro with strong supply
Series A	Multi-city US + 1st intl	Category-leader milestones	International beachhead in London
Series B	**12 cities (target)**	**Category leader**	**Strategic optionality**

Acquisition
Local creator partnerships · campus & neighborhood ambassadors · referrals from satisfied cohorts.

Activation
Free first hang. Conversion to paid happens at hang #2 — once the friend-graph effect kicks in.

Retention
AI-warmed group chats sustain weekly cohorts above category benchmark.

The $10 hang, end-to-end.

Per attendee

Average revenue / attendee	**$10.00**
Payment processing (Stripe)	-$0.59
AI host inference (Haiku-class)	-$0.01
Infra (compute, DB, CDN)	-$0.05
Event-supply APIs (free at current volume)	$0.00
Contribution margin	**≈$9.35 · 94%**

Software-only model: no hosts, no venues, no per-event COGS. Cohort LTV will be reported once paid traction is established.

Nobody else owns the small-group hang.

	SMALL GROUPS	REAL ACTIVITY	PRE-EVENT CHAT	RECURRING CONTACT	AI HOST
Meetup	—	✓	—	—	—
Bumble BFF	✓	—	✓	—	—
Timeleft	✓	✓	—	—	—
Pie / 222	✓	✓	—	—	—
Eventbrite	—	✓	—	—	—
Partiful	—	✓	✓	—	—
Rekindled	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

The only column that predicts friendship is the one nobody owns: **recurring small-group contact.**

From one city to a category.

Q2 '26

Close pre-seed · scale NYC to 5K MAU

Open new neighborhoods (Brooklyn, Queens). Ship matching v2 with vibe-based clustering and friend-of-friend signals.

Q3 '26

Prove NYC unit economics · ship Rekindled AI v2

Memory-based AI host that references past hangs. Hit retention milestones that unlock the Seed round.

Q4 '26

Raise Seed · launch second city

Lift NYC playbook into a second metro with strong Eventbrite/Ticketmaster supply. Pilot B2B "Team Rekindled" with 1–2 hybrid-work companies.

Q2 '27

Multi-city · path to Series A

3-city presence, target ARR & MAU milestones to support a Series A. International beachhead in London on the horizon.

Built by people who lived the problem.

Vinamra

Rahul

Nikhil

Maanas

ROUND

$500K

Pre-seed · valuation TBD · 12-month runway

Round open. Existing commitments and lead status to be confirmed before circulating.

USE OF FUNDS

Engineering — 50% · $250K

1 senior eng hire · matching v2 · AI host v2 · founder salaries

NYC growth — 25% · $125K

Paid acquisition tests · creator partnerships · neighborhood ambassadors

Operations & infra — 15% · $75K

Stripe · legal · cloud infra · Eventbrite/Ticketmaster API access

Brand & reserve — 10% · $50K

Brand work · runway buffer to next raise milestone

Stop waiting for someone to *invite you.*

WEB

rekindled.social